

Flamingo Rise

REAL TOOLS. BRIGHTER TOMORROWS.

A MORE
AWARE YOU
CREATES A BRIGHTER
TOMORROW.



Self-Awareness Reflection WORKBOOK

A practical tool to help
you understand your
emotions, thoughts and
behaviours so you can
make **clearer choices**
and a life that feels
more like you.



PAUSE

EXPLORE

GROW

BECAUSE REAL CHANGE
STARTS WITH AWARENESS.

Awareness
Today
A Brighter
You Tomorrow



SELF-AWARENESS REFLECTION WORKBOOK

Welcome — Meet Yourself Properly

You spend every single day with yourself.

You'd think that would mean you know yourself pretty fucking well.

And yet...

We can spend years repeating the same reactions, choosing the same people, avoiding the same situations, having the same arguments and wondering why the same shit keeps happening.

That's where self-awareness comes in.

Self-awareness isn't endlessly analysing yourself until you've discovered seventeen childhood reasons why you didn't answer an email.

It's being able to notice:

What am I feeling?

What am I thinking?

What am I doing?

Why might I be doing it?

And most importantly:

Is it actually working for me?

We're not here to judge everything you discover.

But we're also not going to pretend every behaviour is fine simply because there's a reason behind it.

Understanding why you do something explains it.

It doesn't always excuse it.

And once you can see a pattern clearly, you get something incredibly useful:

Choice.

Let's have a look.

1. What Are You Actually Feeling?

Let's start with emotions.

Not:

"Fine."

Fine isn't going to cut it here. 😏

Think about the last week.

What emotions showed up most often?

Happy · Angry · Anxious · Content · Frustrated · Sad · Excited · Lonely · Overwhelmed · Calm · Jealous · Guilty · Resentful · Hopeful · Scared · Irritated · Proud · Disappointed

Or something completely different.

The emotions I noticed most were:

Now dig a little deeper.

When did they tend to appear?

Who was I with?

What was happening?

Did I acknowledge the emotion or immediately try to get rid of it?

And:

Was the emotion actually about what was happening — or did the situation poke something older?

You don't need a profound answer.

We're looking for patterns.

2. Trigger or Just Something You Didn't Like?

Trigger has become a word we sometimes use for absolutely anything that pisses us off.

So let's separate things.

Something can:

Trigger a deeper emotional response.

Remind you of a previous experience.

Cross a boundary.

Challenge your beliefs.

Make you uncomfortable.

Or simply:

Annoy the living shit out of you.

Those aren't necessarily the same thing.

Choose one strong emotional reaction from this week.

What happened?

What did I feel?

What did I immediately THINK it meant?

What evidence did I actually have for that interpretation?

Could there have been another explanation?

And:

What exactly was I reacting to — the event, or the meaning I gave it?

That's where self-awareness starts getting interesting.

3. Reaction vs Response

Feelings happen.

Behaviour is what happens next.

You don't always control the first flash of anger, fear, jealousy or frustration.

You do have responsibility for what you do with it.

Think about a recent situation where you reacted strongly.

What happened?

What did I feel?

What did I do?

What did I WANT to do?

What happened because of my response?

Now imagine you could replay it.

Would I respond the same way?

If yes — fine.

Maybe your response was completely appropriate.

If no:

What would I do differently?

Self-awareness isn't about never reacting badly.

It's about recognising when you have — **and learning something from it.**

4. What Story Did Your Brain Tell You?

Your brain is constantly interpreting things.

Someone doesn't reply.

Your brain:

"They're pissed off with me."

Someone disagrees.

"They don't respect me."

You make a mistake.

"I'm fucking useless."

Something goes well.

"Probably luck."

The interpretation can feel like a fact.

It isn't necessarily one.

What thoughts keep showing up for me?

For each one ask:

Is this actually true?

What evidence supports it?

What evidence doesn't?

Am I mind-reading?

Am I predicting an outcome I can't possibly know yet?

Am I treating one experience as proof that something ALWAYS happens?

And:

What would be a more accurate version?

Not more positive.

More accurate.

That's our rule.

5. Spot the Pattern

Now zoom out.

Think about situations that repeatedly cause problems.

Maybe:

You withdraw when you're upset.

Get defensive when criticised.

Say yes and resent it later.

Over-explain yourself.

Avoid difficult conversations.

Need reassurance.

Assume rejection.

Try to fix everybody's problems.

Procrastinate when something matters.

Become controlling when you feel uncertain.

Make jokes when something gets too vulnerable.

Which patterns do I recognise in myself?

Then choose one.

When does this usually happen?

What am I feeling immediately beforehand?

What am I trying to avoid, protect or get?

What does this behaviour give me in the short term?

What does it cost me in the long term?

And the bastard:

If I know this pattern isn't helping me, why do I keep doing it?

There is usually a payoff.

Even shitty patterns survive because somewhere along the line **they worked**.

Find out what yours is doing for you.

6. Explanation Isn't Exemption

This section matters.

Maybe you've discovered exactly why you react a certain way.

Brilliant.

That understanding can give you compassion for yourself.

But:

Knowing why you do something doesn't automatically make the behaviour okay.

You might struggle with trust because you've been betrayed.

That explains why trust is difficult.

It doesn't give you unlimited permission to control somebody else.

You might avoid conflict because confrontation used to feel unsafe.

Understandable.

But refusing to communicate can still damage your relationships.

Two things can be true:

There's a valid reason I developed this behaviour.

AND

I'm responsible for what I do with it now.

Think about one behaviour you'd normally defend with:

"I'm like this because..."

Finish the sentence.

Now ask:

Does the reason explain my behaviour — or am I using it to avoid changing it?

Ouch.

Useful though. 😂

7. What Are Your Behaviours Actually Creating?

KEEP DOING

What behaviours are helping my:

Relationships?

Confidence?

Health?

Work?

Peace of mind?

Future?

STOP OR CHANGE

Which behaviours repeatedly create problems?

Now choose ONE.

The behaviour:

What usually triggers it:

What I normally do:

What I could try instead:

We're not redesigning your entire personality before Tuesday.

One pattern.

One alternative.

Test it.

8. How Do Other People Experience You?

Here's one people don't always enjoy. 😂

Self-awareness isn't only about **how you experience yourself**.

Other people experience you too.

Think about people who know you well.

What would they probably say are my strengths?

What would they say I do when I'm stressed?

What would they say I struggle to hear?

What behaviour of mine might frustrate them?

What would they say I don't give myself enough credit for?

You don't have to agree with every imagined answer.

But if the same feedback has come from **several completely unrelated people over several years...**

Maybe don't immediately yeet it into the fucking bin. 😂

Sometimes feedback is wrong.

Sometimes it's information.

Learn to tell the difference.

9. Your Personal Operating Manual

Now we're going to turn everything you've noticed into something useful.

Complete these:

I tend to feel overwhelmed when...

When I'm hurt, I often...

When I'm scared, I tend to...

When I'm angry, I tend to...

When I feel safe, I...

I communicate best when...

I shut down when...

Something I need but don't always communicate is...

One pattern I'm actively working on is...

One strength I need to remember is...

That's you learning your own operating manual.

No diagnostic label required.

Just information.

Final Reflection — Now What?

Self-awareness without action can become another form of procrastination.

You can understand yourself beautifully and **still keep doing exactly the same shit.**

So finish with:

What surprised me?

What pattern became clearer?

Where am I being unfair to myself?

Where am I making excuses for myself?

What do I need to communicate better?

What behaviour do I want to change?

What's one thing I'm going to try differently this week?

A Final FlamingoRise Note

You don't need to analyse every thought, feeling and questionable decision you've made since birth.

The goal isn't to become **perfectly self-aware**.

It's to catch yourself often enough that you stop living entirely on autopilot.

Notice the emotion.

Question the story.

Own the behaviour.

Change what isn't working.

Keep what is.

And occasionally admit:

“Yep. That one's on me.”

That's not failure.

That's fucking useful.

Because once you can see yourself clearly, **you have choices you didn't have when you weren't looking.**

Pause. Explore. Grow.

Rise. Heal. Soar. 🦩